

Tips on Scanning Different Types of Documents

Document type	Resolution Settings
Magazine Page	300 dpi, 48-bit
News Paper	200 dpi, 48-bit
Excel Sheet	150 dpi, 48-bit
Typed Document	200 dpi, 48-bit
Fax	200 dpi, 48-bit
Photo-copied Document	200 dpi, 48-bit

business users, and therefore awarded 20 per cent, features got 20 per cent, and the price tag was given a 10 per cent weightage. The calculated STTI scores, coupled with price, offered the best scanners for business users. We determined that all scanners scoring above the 60 STTI mark, and falling within the price range of Rs 3,950 to Rs 11,000, are ideal candidates for the business user.

The best scanner for Business users

This category also saw the newer USB 2.0 interface scanners, which were expected to do better in the speed tests; the rest of the sub-systems being on par. We had mixed results from various scanners, with HP, Canon and Umax giving excellent results in one area but averaging in another. This made for an interesting category.

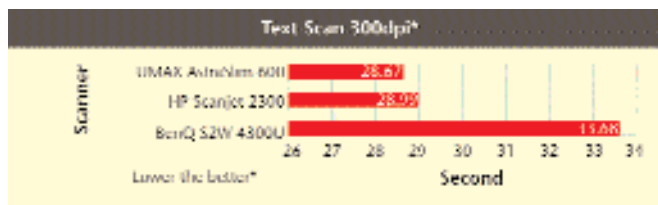
If you are looking for a scanner that can do both, preview and scan the documents with speed, then the Umax Astra 2500 is the best choice. Although it wasn't the fastest draw while previewing documents (Benq S2W 5000E took 7.54 seconds), its score of 8.47 seconds is not bad by any means. When you couple this with the low time of 16.19 seconds taken to scan a text



The Microtech 3800 is a decent performer for the Business area

document at 300 dpi, as is widely practised in an office, the speed achieved eliminates the need to have more than one scanner per department.

Climbing up the dpi-ladder towards high-quality photo scanning, the Canon CanoScan LIDE 30 took less than 4 minutes to scan a full-colour photo at the respectable resolution of 1200 dpi. This USB 2.0-interface machine, slim and compact as it is, took just 211.39 seconds to complete the Herculean task, hence making it the perfect choice for high-quality scanning at a good speed. Furthermore, it just needs a USB cable for data-transfer and power supply, thereby reducing desk clutter and eliminating the need to locate it near a power jack, the same was the case with Umax AstraSlim 600, which was drawing power from the USB interface. A dark metallic-blue colour adds to its aesthetic appeal. Couple this with the three hot keys that let it



Following this thought-process, we formed the benchmarks that included speed (which was awarded 30 per cent), followed by quality (which was given 20 per cent). Warranty and support are also important for the



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